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Trump called FBI agents after seizure of Ga. ballots

Conversation, appearance of Gabbard at site part of his bid to prove vote fraud

By William K. Rashbaum, Devlin Barrett, and Julian E. Barnes
NEW YORK TIMES

By any measure, the FBI's search of an election center in Fulton County, Georgia, last week was extraordinary. Agents seized truckloads of 2020 ballots, as President Trump harnessed the levers of government to not only buttress his false claims of widespread voter fraud, but also to try to build a criminal case against those he believes wronged him.

What happened the next day was in some ways even more unusual, The New York Times has learned.

Behind closed doors, Tulsi Gabbard, the director of national intelligence, met with some of the same FBI agents, members of the bureau's field office in Atlanta, which is conducting the election inquiry, three people with knowledge of the meeting said. They could not say why Gabbard, who also appeared on site at the search, was there, but her continued presence has raised eyebrows given that her role overseeing the nation's intelligence agencies does not include on-site involvement in criminal investigative work.

What occurred during the meeting was even further, FBI, Page A4

Can compassion in its reporting save newspaper?

Christian Science Monitor tries to regain status with new leaders, old ideals

By Aidan Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

The Christian Science Monitor was once one of the nation's most prominent newspapers, rising above its unorthodox status as a church-owned paper to garner seven Pulitzer Prizes.

But it's been decades since its heyday. The publication's solutions-focused journalism has been drowned out by social media, podcasts, and streaming services. Paid subscribers have declined from 223,000 in 1970 to about 25,000 today, and its full-time staff has fallen from nearly 160 at the start of the century to roughly 60 in 2025.

Now, a new crop of leaders at its Back Bay newsroom is trying to reverse the years of decline with a print and digital redesign, the launch of an app, and expanding efforts on platforms such as Apple News. The Monitor is also seeking to double down on its founding mission "to injure no man, but to bless all mankind" and capture a broader range of perspectives in its reporting, including conservative voices that its editor said are often

MONITOR, Page A6

ICE transfer operations spark uncertainty and fear in Maine

Detainees swiftly sent to distant facilities, leaving families in dark

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio
GLOBE STAFF

Families of immigrants arrested in a federal surge in Maine last month are scrambling to find out even basic information about their loved ones, as the government swiftly transfers them to detention facilities hundreds of miles away.

Erik Orellana-Mejia's family spends their

days next to the phone, wondering when he will call — and from where. Since Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents arrested him at his worksite on Jan. 20 in Maine, the agency has taken him to Massachusetts, Rhode Island, Louisiana, and, most recently, to Missouri.

Orellana-Mejia's family — his two teenagers, his wife, and his stepdaughter — have sometimes gone days at a time without hearing from him.

"There are so many unknowns," said his wife, Debra Orellana-Mejia. "It's been really hard on our family, with just too many gaps [in] communication."

Since last year, ICE has been building out a detention and deportation machinery in New England and across the country as it intensifies enforcement operations. The agency relied on this infrastructure to quickly send Maine residents it arrested to detention facilities across the country.

ICE said it arrested more than 200 people in Maine from Jan. 20-24, in what the agency dubbed "Operation Catch of the Day." Though US Senator Susan Collins of Maine announced Thursday that Department of Homeland Security Secretary Kristi Noem informed her the department would end the

DETAIN, Page A7



PHOTOS BY ERIN CLARK/GLOBE STAFF

Debra Orellana-Mejia in the family's Portland, Maine, home with two of their children after her husband's ICE arrest.

Judge's reprieve heartens local Haitians

Protected status remains, but US vows to appeal

By Danny McDonald and Tonya Alanez
GLOBE STAFF

The legal status of tens of thousands of Haitians in Massachusetts remained uncertain Monday, even after a federal judge blocked the Trump administration's bid to end their Temporary Protected Status shielding them from deportation.

The Department of Homeland Security said late Monday it will appeal the ruling by a Wash-

ington, D.C., judge to the Supreme Court, making the long-term status of Haitians uncertain.

"Temporary means temporary and the final word will not be from an activist judge legislating from the bench," the department said in a statement.

Despite the government's vow to appeal the ruling, the temporary reprieve was welcome news for officials and others who work with Massachusetts' large Haitian population.

"This ruling is important for Haitian families here. It also protects against a harmful disruption to the Massachusetts' economy, as Haitian TPS hold-

ers are an integral part of our workforce, particularly in the health care sector," Governor Maura Healey said in a statement. "If President Trump had his way, thousands of nurses, home health aides, and other essential employees would not have been able to work tomorrow, and patients and families who are dependent on caregivers would have suffered."

US District Judge Ana Reyes's ruling came on the night before Temporary Protected Status, which allows immigrants from a country in crisis to live and work in the US, was set to expire on Tuesday. The protections for Haiti had been

45,000
Haitians in the Boston area with Temporary Protected Status

in place since a devastating earthquake in 2010.

Reyes called for a pause in the termination of TPS while a lawsuit challenging it moves forward. "During the stay, the termination shall be null, void, and of no legal effect," Reyes wrote.

Reyes said in an accompanying 83-page opinion that plaintiffs were likely to prevail on the merits of the case, and that she found it "substantially likely"

HAITIANS, Page A7



In the news

All seven victims in the sinking of a fishing vessel from Gloucester were identified by the Coast Guard. **B1.**

President Trump urged the House to quickly vote to end the partial government shut-down. **A2.**

Bill and Hillary Clinton, in a change of tactics, agreed to testify in a House investigation into the convicted sex offender Jeffrey Epstein, just days before the House was expected to vote to hold them in criminal contempt of Congress. **A5.**

Zipcar, the car-sharing service that started in Cambridge, revealed it is cutting its local ties, leading to the layoffs of 126 workers. **D1.**

Malcolm Butler, the hero of the last Super Bowl match the Patriots had with the Seahawks, talks about his immaculate interception. **C1.**

Glow ray aaahh

Tuesday: Warmer, lots of sun. High 36-41, low 16-21.

Wednesday: Some sun. High 31-36, low 12-17.

Sunrise: 6:56. Sunset: 5:01.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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ARMS AND HAMMER



STAN GROSSFELD/GLOBE STAFF

Blacksmith John Hayden separates the wood grip from a gun at his shop in Waltham. Hayden is part of an effort to turn the wood and steel from discarded weapons into garden tools. **B1.**

Amid turmoil over SNAP, caseworker offers steady calm

By Mara Kardas-Nelson
GLOBE STAFF

On a recent Thursday in January, the Jackson Square office of the Department of Transitional Assistance was quiet. The humming of the heating system gave off white noise, the walls and carpets tones of sea green, light blue, and white. A few people sat in the waiting area. None spoke.

The relative calm here stood in contrast with the recent tumult over the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program, or SNAP, the federal food support program the department administers to roughly a million Massachusetts residents.

Over several months, the Trump administration has rolled out major changes to the program, including work requirements that went into effect Sunday. The overhaul was com-

CASEWORK, Page A6

MONEY, POWER, INEQUALITY

Examining the racial wealth gap